

MASSFRONT

Faction Lore Bible

Three sovereign civilizations. One neutral galactic institution. One infestation outside the political order.

STATUS	WORKING CANON + PROPOSAL LEDGER
DATE	2026-08-28
PLAYABLE	NOVA COALITION // CRIMSON DOMINION // SYNDICATE COALITION
NON-SELECTABLE	UGA // CORPORATIONS // INTERNAL ORGANIZATIONS // BROOD



Contents

Canon authority, political structure, faction profiles, territorial rules, commanders, sponsors, UGA doctrine, the Brood exception, and implementation boundaries.

1. Canon authority

2. Core setting premise

3. The galactic political order

4. Naming authority

5. Territorial and civic rules

6. Nova Coalition

7. Crimson Dominion

8. Syndicate Coalition

9. United Galactic Authority

4

4

5

5

6

6

8

10

12

6.1 Identity

6.2 Government and society

6.3 Territory and settlements

6.4 Non-selectable internal organizations

6.5 Commanders

6.6 Proposed sponsor corporations

7.1 Identity

7.2 Government and society

7.3 Territory and settlements

7.4 Non-selectable internal organizations

7.5 Commanders

7.6 Proposed state combines and sponsors

8.1 Identity

8.2 Government and society

8.3 Territory and settlements

8.4 Non-selectable internal organizations

8.5 Commanders

8.6 Proposed sponsor corporations

9.1 Definition

9.2 Neutrality doctrine

9.3 Proposed institutions

6

7

7

8

8

8

8

9

9

10

10

10

10

11

11

12

12

12

13

13

9.4 Jurisdiction and administered places

9.5 Membership and force limits

9.6 UGA support and procurement

10. The Brood exception14

10.1 What the Brood is

10.2 Infestation lifecycle

10.3 Vespera

10.4 Strategic minds and strains

10.5 Communication rule

11. Corporations and sponsorship16

11.1 Player-facing sponsorship model

12. Commander presentation rules17

12.1 Character authority

12.2 Visual canon

12.3 Writing voices

13. Inter-faction relations17

Nova and the Crimson Dominion

Nova and the Syndicate Coalition

Crimson Dominion and the Syndicate Coalition

The sovereign powers and the UGA

Civilization and the Brood

14. Narrative architecture18

14.1 Faction arcs

14.2 Shared campaign spine

15. World and colony dossier standard19

16. Working historical sequence19

17. Optional exploration-module boundary20

18. Canon locks and forbidden implications20

19. Open canon decisions21

20. Source and proposal ledger21

Live base sources consulted

Optional sources consulted

Implementation consequences for later stages

1. Canon authority

This document reconciles the current game text with the setting direction established by the creator. It is intended to become the narrative source of truth, but it does not silently turn every new name into finished canon.

The labels used throughout are:

- **DIRECTED CANON** - a rule or identity established directly by the creator. This overrides conflicting legacy wording.
- **LIVE CANON** - a fact already represented in the current base-game source.
- **WORKING CANON** - the recommended reconciliation of directed and live canon. It may be written against, but its final name or detail still needs a creator lock.
- **PROPOSED** - new material offered for approval. It must not be presented as shipped history until approved.
- **OPTIONAL CONCEPT** - material from the isolated space-exploration module. It is not automatically base-game canon.
- **LEGACY ALIAS** - an older name that may remain in save keys, dialogue, or technical identifiers without defining a separate political entity.

Canon precedence is:

1. Direct creator corrections.
2. Approved entries in this lore bible.
3. Current shipped narrative and faction data.
4. Optional-module concepts.
5. Older planning notes, technical labels, and aliases.

Mechanics alone do not establish lore. A technical key, AI roster entry, resident-faction flag, or proxy label cannot create a new government, species, or selectable faction.

2. Core setting premise

MASSFRONT takes place across a contested galactic theatre linked by strategic transit and mass-energy infrastructure. Three sovereign powers govern populated worlds, cities, colonies, and stations. Their wars are political: they fight over security, territory, industry, information, resources, and the right to define the next interstellar order.

Above their rivalry sits the **United Galactic Authority**, a treaty institution intended to keep civilization connected without becoming a galactic empire. Outside that political order is the **Brood**, an infestation that does not conquer in any civilized sense. It consumes life, transforms environments, and replaces inhabited space with a living predatory ecology.

The central dramatic question is not simply which army wins. It is whether incompatible civilizations can preserve a shared galaxy when faced with something that erases civilization itself.

3. The galactic political order

Entity	Classification	Territory	Selectable	Command role
Nova Coalition	Sovereign coalition	Governs member worlds, colonies, cities, and stations	Yes	Player chooses a Nova commander under Terran Frontline Command
Crimson Dominion	Sovereign authoritarian state	Governs dominion worlds, prefectures, fortress cities, and industrial colonies	Yes	Player chooses a Dominion commander shaped by the Red Ascendancy
Syndicate Coalition	Sovereign charter coalition	Governs charter worlds, city-states, commercial colonies, and stations	Yes	Player chooses a Syndicate commander or director
United Galactic Authority	Neutral intergovernmental institution	Administers treaty sites and temporary mandates; does not own member worlds	No	Mediator, relief coordinator, standards body, peacekeeper, and containment authority
Brood	Extragalactic or extra-planar infestation	Infests and consumes; never governs	No	Hostile AI threat represented by strategic hive minds

The relationship is deliberately asymmetric:

```
Sovereign political order
|- Nova Coalition
| \- Terran Frontline Command and other non-selectable institutions
|- Crimson Dominion
| \- Red Ascendancy and other non-selectable institutions
\ - Syndicate Coalition
   \- charter blocs, directorates, and non-selectable corporations

Treaty order
\ - United Galactic Authority
   \- delegations, courts, relief agencies, peacekeepers, and mandates

Outside the political order
\ - Brood
   \- hives, strains, gestation organs, and linked strategic minds
```

4. Naming authority

Stable identity	Canonical lore use	Subordinate or associated identity	Legacy or technical labels
nova	Nova Coalition	Terran Frontline Command is its principal expeditionary military arm	Nova Federation, Federation, Frontline Command
dominion	Crimson Dominion	Red Ascendancy is its founding movement, ruling ideology, and military-political order	Legion, Ascendancy, Bloodward Legion, runtime key <code>legion</code>
syndicate	Syndicate Coalition	Member charters, directorates, guilds, city-states, and corporate blocs	Machine Ascendancy, Emerald Triad
brood	Brood or Brood Swarm	Hives, strains, and strategic organisms	Horde, Umbral Brood, Infestation Swarm, runtime key <code>horde</code>
uga	United Galactic Authority	Treaty institutions and authorized missions	UGA

WORKING CANON: The red naming problem is resolved by making the **Crimson Dominion** the state and the **Red Ascendancy** the movement that founded and governs it. They are not two selectable factions.

DIRECTED CANON: Terran Frontline Command belongs to the Nova Coalition; it is not a fourth polity beside Nova.

DIRECTED CANON: Internal blocs, military formations, corporations, and sponsors are never separate selectable factions.

5. Territorial and civic rules

The three sovereign factions must read as civilizations, not armies with a single battlefield.

Their territorial hierarchy is:

```
Sovereign polity
\ - controlled systems or treaty-recognized claims
  \ - worlds
    | - planetary governments or appointed administrations
    | - cities and regional capitals
    | - colonies and industrial concessions
  \ - orbital stations, ports, relays, and defence networks
```

Every sovereign faction may have:

- a capital or political seat;
- multiple governed worlds and colony claims;
- cities with civilian populations and local administrations;
- frontier colonies with different legal arrangements from the core;
- military bases that answer to civilian, imperial, or charter authority;
- corporations operating under licenses, concessions, or public contracts;
- disputed borders and treaty obligations;
- residents who are not soldiers.

Every location must carry exactly one primary legal status:

- **Sovereign** - governed by a recognized polity.
- **Disputed** - claimed by more than one polity.
- **Treaty-neutral** - sovereign ownership exists, but military or commercial use is limited by treaty.
- **UGA-administered** - held temporarily under a defined multilateral mandate; not UGA sovereign territory.
- **Quarantined** - access controlled because of infestation, contamination, or another civilization-scale hazard.
- **Infested** - Brood organisms have established a self-spreading ecology.
- **Consumed** - organized civilian life and ordinary governance have collapsed under the Brood.
- **Abandoned** - no active recognized administration, without necessarily being infested.

The UGA **administers**. Sovereign factions **govern, control, or claim**. The Brood **infests, consumes, transforms, or renders a world lost**.

6. Nova Coalition

6.1 Identity

DIRECTED / WORKING CANON: The Nova Coalition is a sovereign alliance of self-governing worlds and colonies. Its legitimacy comes from common defence, shared infrastructure, representative compacts, and the promise that technical progress should protect civilian life.

Terran Frontline Command is the Coalition's best-known military arm. It is a combined-arms expeditionary command built around hardened positions, precision fire, disciplined advance, and dependable logistics. It may be the selectable banner in the current war without being the whole Nova civilization.

LIVE CANON motto: DISCIPLINE. TECHNOLOGY. UNITY. **LIVE CANON public ideal:** For peace. For the people. For tomorrow.

Nova's central tension is the gap between representative ideals and emergency command. Its people accept strong coordinated defence because frontier worlds cannot survive disunity, but every prolonged crisis risks turning temporary military authority into permanent rule.

6.2 Government and society

PROPOSED constitutional model:

- A coalition assembly represents member worlds and major chartered colonies.
- A civil executive coordinates transit, science, reconstruction, and interworld standards.
- Member worlds retain local law unless a defence compact or emergency mandate applies.
- Terran Frontline Command answers to civilian authority but receives broad operational discretion in an active theatre.
- Frontier governors combine elected local councils with professional emergency administrators.
- Citizenship emphasizes civil service, technical education, disaster readiness, and mutual defence rather than compulsory military identity.

Nova cities should feel inhabited, organized, and maintained: transit grids, civil shelters, public fabrication yards, universities, defence infrastructure, and carefully planned expansion zones. Even its fortifications should imply that people live behind them.

6.3 Territory and settlements

LIVE CANON anchor: Aelos, in **Sombrero-I**, is Nova's featured homeworld and the seat of the current Frontline campaign.

Existing Aelos place anchors:

Location	Working civic interpretation	Status
Capital Circumference / Command Circumference	Planetary capital belt and Coalition command district	LIVE CANON name; civic role refined here
Heartland Foundry / Heartland Yards	Heavy fabrication, repair, and public-works region	LIVE CANON
Port Admiralty / Harbor Command	Naval, orbital-transfer, and disaster-logistics port	LIVE CANON
Great Divide Gate / High Shelf	Frontier defence, transit, and continental access corridor	LIVE CANON

DIRECTED CANON: Aelos is not Nova's only inhabited possession. The Coalition governs additional worlds, colony settlements, and stations even where their final names have not yet been locked.

PROPOSED expansion slots:

- one established agricultural or ecological colony that demonstrates Nova civilian life outside Aelos;
- one high-risk scientific frontier world whose research charter tests Coalition oversight;
- one reconstruction colony jointly supported by the UGA after an earlier war;
- one strategic orbital shipyard or transit station administered by Nova under treaty inspection.

Optional names such as **Caldris Orbital Ring** may be retained later as Aelos orbital infrastructure, but the exploration module's use of "Aelos" as a system conflicts with the base game's use of Aelos as a planet and is not adopted here.

6.4 Non-selectable internal organizations

Organization	Function	Canon status
Terran Frontline Command	Coalition expeditionary and theatre military command	DIRECTED + LIVE
Federation Expeditionary Command	Legacy or constitutional service name within Nova's armed forces	LIVE; hierarchy needs final wording
Fourth Landing Group	Major landing and occupation-relief formation	LIVE
Third Striker Company	Frontline reporting and combat formation	LIVE
Federation Corps of Engineers	Fortification, recovery, construction, and field infrastructure	LIVE
Forward Works Detachment	Deployed engineering formation	LIVE
Reconnaissance Doctrine Office	Intelligence, reconnaissance standards, and battlefield doctrine	LIVE

These organizations provide characters, missions, doctrine, equipment, and political pressure. None is separately selectable.

6.5 Commanders

Commander	Role	Narrative identity	Canon status
Captain Elara Kai	Vanguard	"The Clean Landing"; wins by precision, restraint, and decisive force	LIVE
Major Rowan Holt	Engineer	"Forward Works"; builds positions meant to outlast the campaign	LIVE
Commander Sera Vale	Tactician	"Long Sight"; reads the battlefield before others accept what is coming	LIVE

6.6 Proposed sponsor corporations

Sponsor	Specialty	Typical sponsorship
Aegis Frontier Works	Defensive systems and hardened civil engineering	Shields, armor packages, fortification prototypes
Kestrel Aerospace Cooperative	Aerospace, sensors, and lift systems	Aircraft gear, reconnaissance packages, airlift contracts
Horizon Fabrication Union	Construction and modular industry	Workshop gear, build support, mass-processing grants
Farline Logistics	Transit, fuel, and distributed supply	Energy reserves, supply drops, recovery contracts

All four names are **PROPOSED**. Their products may be selected as sponsorships or rewards; the companies themselves never replace the Nova Coalition on the faction screen.

7. Crimson Dominion

7.1 Identity

LIVE / WORKING CANON: The Crimson Dominion is an authoritarian sovereign state built around armored strength, hierarchy, industrial control, and the belief that survival proves the right to rule. The **Red Ascendancy** began as a movement that rejected Nova restraint and now functions as the Dominion's governing ideology and elite political-military order.

The Dominion is not merely cruel for spectacle. It offers security, infrastructure, clear authority, and rapid mobilization to worlds that fear collapse. Its central contradiction is that a system built to prevent disorder requires permanent enemies and permanent emergency.

LIVE CANON motto: STRENGTH. AUTHORITY. CONQUEST. **LIVE CANON command creed:** The weak are fuel. The strong ascend.

7.2 Government and society

PROPOSED governing model:

- The Dominion is divided into territorial prefectures governed by appointed authorities.
- Military and industrial offices overlap; foundries, logistics, and defence are treated as state functions.
- Fortress cities receive protection and resources in exchange for production quotas and political obedience.
- Citizenship tiers are tied to service, technical value, family standing, or demonstrated loyalty.
- Local customs may survive when they do not obstruct quotas, mobilization, or Ascendancy doctrine.
- Military governors can assume emergency authority, but the definition of emergency is deliberately broad.

Dominion civilian life should show order under pressure: pressure-dome cities, subterranean foundries, ceremonial courts, state housing, ration networks, martial schools, and public monuments to continuity through strength.

7.3 Territory and settlements

LIVE CANON anchor: Pyraeth, in **Andromeda-IV**, is the Dominion's featured homeworld and its principal war-forge theatre.

Location	Working civic interpretation	Status
Court of Iron / Buried Court	Political seat, military tribunal, and ceremonial capital	LIVE CANON name; civic role refined here
Promethean Mega-Grid / Mech Foundry	Foundry arcology and armored-production zone	LIVE CANON
Ignis Dome Court / Dome Arcology	Protected urban population center under prefectural rule	LIVE CANON
Hub Delta Pads / Orbital Aprons	Storm-lashed military and freight spaceport	LIVE CANON

DIRECTED CANON: The Dominion governs additional worlds, colonies, cities, and extraction territories beyond Pyraeth.

PROPOSED expansion slots:

- one fortress colony established to hold a contested transit corridor;
- one resource world governed directly by an industrial prefecture;
- one annexed civilian world whose local identity survives beneath Dominion rule;
- one penal or service colony that exposes the moral cost of Ascendancy citizenship.

7.4 Non-selectable internal organizations

Organization	Function	Canon status
Red Ascendancy	Founding movement, ruling doctrine, and elite order	LIVE name; WORKING political role
First Wardens	Vex's elite formation and coercive symbol	LIVE
Crimson Advance	Operational command built around sustained offensive tempo	LIVE
Prefecture of Fortifications	Fortress construction, siege defence, and territorial hardening	LIVE concept
Dominion Iron Assembly	Potential industrial mission authority, not a replacement faction name	OPTIONAL CONCEPT, pending reconciliation

7.5 Commanders

Commander	Role	Narrative identity	Canon status
Lord Darion Vex	Juggernaut	"The Grading Hand"; treats war as proof of who deserves authority	LIVE
Marshal Rhea Korr	Warmaster	"Cadence"; turns unbroken forward motion into doctrine	LIVE
Prefect Amon Dravik	Fortifier	"The Iron Mandate"; builds the wall the counterattack must break upon	LIVE

7.6 Proposed state combines and sponsors

Sponsor	Specialty	Typical sponsorship
Pyraeth State Arsenal	Artillery and siege ordnance	Ammunition, targeting packages, bombardment contracts
Red Mantle Foundries	Heavy armor and chassis production	Armor kits, vehicle replacements, prototype hulls
Mandate Reactor Combine	Reactors and high-energy weapon systems	Energy reserves, reactor upgrades, weapon trials
Bastion Supply Authority	Alloys, fortification, and replacement logistics	Defensive materials, garrison supply, emergency reconstruction

These are **PROPOSED** and may function more like state combines than independent firms. None has political sovereignty or a faction-selection slot.

8. Syndicate Coalition

8.1 Identity

DIRECTED + LIVE CANON: The Syndicate Coalition is a sovereign coalition of charter worlds, city-states, guilds, commercial houses, technical directorates, and corporate blocs. It governs through negotiated charters, arbitration, reputation, and enforceable contracts rather than a single royal or military chain.

Its promise is freedom through voluntary association, information, and access to markets. Its danger is that rights become products and power belongs to whoever can afford the strongest contract.

LIVE CANON motto: ADAPT. PROFIT. SURVIVE. **LIVE CANON political creed:** Information is power. Profit is freedom.

8.2 Government and society

PROPOSED governing model:

- Member worlds ratify a shared coalition charter while retaining different local constitutions.
- A rotating arbitration board settles disputes between governments, guilds, and corporate members.
- Coalition law guarantees transit, contract enforcement, data standards, and mutual defence.
- City citizenship, professional membership, and commercial residency may coexist.
- Corporations can administer concessions or infrastructure, but a sovereign charter and applicable public law must always be named.
- Autonomous systems may advise or execute policy, but accountability remains a live political fault line.

Syndicate cities should combine civic life with visible commerce: exchange towers, autonomous freight, layered neighborhoods, data markets, salvage yards, contract courts, weather shields, and privately sponsored public systems.

8.3 Territory and settlements

LIVE CANON anchor: Nordhall, in the **Orion Arc**, is the Coalition's featured homeworld and the center of its autonomous defence network.

Location	Working civic interpretation	Status
Archipelago Core Vault / Frostwake Grid	Secured data, finance, and infrastructure district	LIVE CANON name; civic role refined here
Citadel Command Pinnacle / Frontline Shelf	Coalition defence and arbitration command center	LIVE CANON
Pale Trench Reactor / Reactor Rift	Energy-production and industrial concession zone	LIVE CANON
Skyshield Array / Orbital Weather	Climate defence, aerospace, and orbital-control district	LIVE CANON

DIRECTED CANON: The Coalition governs additional worlds, cities, colonies, freeports, and contracted stations beyond Nordhall.

PROPOSED expansion slots:

- one prosperous freeport whose neutrality depends on Coalition arbitration;
- one salvage colony built around a pre-collapse debris field;
- one research world where autonomous governance is being tested;
- one frontier concession whose corporate operator and public government are in open conflict.

Morrow Freeport may be retained from the optional exploration material as a Coalition-aligned station after its galactic location is reconciled.

8.4 Non-selectable internal organizations

Organization	Function	Canon status
Accounts, Field Division	Battlefield finance, recovery, settlement, and resource accounting	LIVE
Infiltration, unlisted	Covert access, intelligence, and deniable operations	LIVE
Directorate of Autonomous Systems	Machine cadres, predictive systems, and automation policy	LIVE
Veil Network	Potential covert logistics and intelligence consortium	OPTIONAL CONCEPT
Machine Ascendancy	Legacy label best retained as a machine-governance doctrine or political bloc	LEGACY ALIAS; proposed internal use
Emerald Triad	Legacy label best retained as a three-member commercial bloc	LEGACY ALIAS; proposed internal use

8.5 Commanders

Commander	Role	Narrative identity	Canon status
Broker Lys Renn	Broker	"The Black Ledger"; converts information, wreckage, and risk into leverage	LIVE
Operative Nyx Calder	Infiltrator	"Ghost Optics"; exists in records only as an equipment anomaly	LIVE
Director Oren Voss	Controller	"The Predictive Core"; tries to engineer delay and uncertainty out of command	LIVE

8.6 Proposed sponsor corporations

Sponsor	Specialty	Typical sponsorship
Meridian Exchange	Resource markets, credit, and market intelligence	Resource advances, price data, procurement access
Ghostline Systems	Cloaking, phase systems, and electronic warfare	Stealth gear, sensor denial, infiltration contracts
Axiom Autonomous	Drones, control networks, and predictive automation	Drone packages, command software, prototype controllers
Nordhall Reclamation Guild	Salvage, recovery, and battlefield recycling	Salvage rights, recovery teams, material bonuses

All names are **PROPOSED**. A sponsor may be powerful enough to pressure a government, but it never becomes a selectable sovereign faction.

9. United Galactic Authority

9.1 Definition

DIRECTED CANON: The **United Galactic Authority** operates like the United Nations and other international institutions on a galactic scale. It is neutral between recognized powers. It is not a fourth sovereign civilization, not a galaxy-wide empire, and not a selectable army.

The UGA exists because transit, refugees, trade standards, contamination, scientific risk, and interstellar war cross borders. Its authority comes from charters, treaties, member consent, court recognition, and narrowly defined emergency mandates.

The UGA does not own or rule the Nova, Dominion, or Syndicate worlds. It may administer a site only when a treaty or time-limited mandate says so.

9.2 Neutrality doctrine

UGA neutrality means:

- no ordinary war aim may favor one member's ideology;
- humanitarian relief is offered by need rather than allegiance;
- treaty inspectors operate under published mandates;
- peacekeepers use force only within an authorized mission, in self-defence, or to protect civilians under that mission;
- arbitration is distinct from conquest;
- an anti-Brood response is civilization-level containment, not support for one faction's territorial ambitions;
- a member fighting the Brood does not gain automatic UGA approval for unrelated annexation or repression.

Neutrality does not require passivity. Rescue, evacuation, quarantine, investigation of reality wounds, protection of relief corridors, and collective defence against active infestation are compatible with the UGA charter.

9.3 Proposed institutions

Institution	Mandate
Assembly of Member Polities	Debate, budgets, treaties, elections, and broad multilateral legitimacy
Galactic Security Council	Emergency mandates, sanctions, peacekeeping, and collective-defence authorization
UGA Secretariat	Civil administration, records, coordination, and implementation
Interstellar Court of Arbitration	Treaty disputes, transit law, claims, and commercial conflicts between polities
Neutral Transit Commission	Lattice access, navigation standards, inspection, and demilitarized corridors
Relief and Reconstruction Agency	Refugees, medical relief, food, shelter, and postwar restoration
Xenothreat Containment Directorate	Brood detection, quarantine, biosafety, and coordinated containment doctrine
Scientific Standards Council	Shared research safety, evidence protocols, and dangerous-technology controls
UGA Expeditionary Command	Limited-mandate peacekeeping, evacuation, escort, and containment coordination

All institution names are **PROPOSED**, except the United Galactic Authority itself.

9.4 Jurisdiction and administered places

The UGA may operate:

- treaty stations;
- diplomatic enclaves hosted on sovereign worlds;
- demilitarized transit corridors;
- inspection and navigation relays;
- emergency refugee settlements under temporary trusteeship;
- quarantine and containment zones;
- shared scientific observatories;
- civilization ships supporting diplomacy, relief, research, and expedition coordination.

NEXUS-VII is the preferred **OPTIONAL CONCEPT** for a UGA civilization ship and neutral operational hub. If adopted, it hosts delegations and missions; their presence does not transfer sovereignty to the UGA.

9.5 Membership and force limits

WORKING CANON: Nova, the Dominion, and the Syndicate all maintain formal relations and accredited missions with the UGA. Their precise status - full member, signatory, observer, sanctioned member, or treaty counterparty - may vary by era and remains to be locked.

UGA force is limited to:

- treaty enforcement accepted by the relevant parties;
- peacekeeping and ceasefire observation;
- civilian protection within an active mandate;
- rescue, evacuation, and corridor defence;
- self-defence;
- quarantine enforcement;
- collectively authorized Brood containment.

The UGA cannot simply end every faction war because it lacks sovereign ownership of member militaries, depends on member funding and consent, and must preserve enough neutrality to remain useful after the shooting stops.

9.6 UGA support and procurement

UGA support may appear as:

- medical and evacuation equipment;
- survey instruments and biosafety gear;
- repair and emergency logistics packages;
- reconstruction grants;
- neutral navigation data;
- anti-infestation equipment certified for joint operations;
- time-limited mission resources.

These are mandate resources, not a hidden fourth-faction tech tree.

10. The Brood exception

10.1 What the Brood is

DIRECTED CANON: The Brood is the only exception to the rule that major factions govern worlds, colonies, and cities. It consumes and infests.

LIVE CANON: The Brood is wholly biological and enters material space through reality wounds connected to the soul plane - the space between the living and the dead. It spreads living territory, mutates under pressure, and overwhelms defence through mass, adaptation, and relentless numbers. It uses no vehicles, factories, or manufactured weapons.

The Brood is not a sovereign state. It has:

- no government;

- no citizenship;
- no civilian population;
- no cities or colonies;
- no corporations;
- no trade or taxation;
- no recognized borders;
- no diplomatic standing;
- no UGA membership;
- no legitimate territorial claims.

10.2 Infestation lifecycle

Stage	Meaning
Reality wound	A breach allows Brood organisms or influence to cross into material space
Incursion	Organisms appear, hunt, seed, and test local resistance
Infestation	A self-sustaining biological network establishes nests, feeder roots, gestation organs, and spore fields
Planetary consumption	The network converts ecosystems, cities, industry, and populations into biomass or hive function
Consumed world	Ordinary governance and civilian continuity cease; the world is lost, dead, or transformed into a hostile living ecology

The Brood does not “capture a city.” It overruns, hollows, digests, nests within, or transforms it. It does not “colonize a planet.” It seeds, infests, and consumes it.

10.3 Vespera

DIRECTED RECONCILIATION: **Vespera**, in the **Helios Core**, is a consumed or actively infested world. It is not the sovereign Brood homeworld. Existing references to a Brood “homeworld” describe the central world of the current Brood theatre, not a lawful seat of government.

Existing site names such as **Great Hive Spire**, **Infestation Fields**, **Magma Hatcheries**, and **Terminator Hive Spire** describe infestation anatomy built through or over swallowed civilization. Their ruined cities, factories, and foundries are evidence of consumption, not Brood urban life.

Vespera’s pre-infestation sovereign and the continuing legal status of its refugees remain open canon decisions.

10.4 Strategic minds and strains

Identity	Interpretation	Selectable
The Brood Sovereign	Strategic organism or distributed command intelligence	No; AI only
The Veil Matron	Organism specialized in widening or exploiting reality wounds	No; AI only
The Ossuary Mind	Death-tide intelligence associated with consumed biomass	No; AI only

These are not kings, elected leaders, corporations, or political subfactions. A “strain” is a biological adaptation and mission variant, not a player allegiance.

PROPOSED strain vocabulary: Sovereign Host, Veil Strain, Ossuary Communion, Tide Broods, and Worldheart Hives. These names require approval and must remain biological classifications.

10.5 Communication rule

Brood communication may appear as intercepted neural pattern, translated sensory impulse, corrupted broadcast, mimicked voice, or collective pressure. It must not read like normal diplomatic correspondence. Apparent negotiation is manipulation, predation, or failed translation unless the creator later establishes otherwise.

11. Corporations and sponsorship

Corporations exist inside the law and territory of the three sovereign factions. They can be influential, transnational, state-owned, cooperative, privately held, or chartered, but they are never selectable factions.

A corporation may:

- sponsor gear or a prototype;
- provide resources, fuel, alloys, components, or research grants;
- issue a mission contract;
- hold a licensed mining, salvage, transit, or fabrication concession;
- operate infrastructure under public law;
- fund a commander or expedition;
- offer a cosmetic livery or manufacturer identity;
- lobby, pressure, bribe, or oppose a government.

A corporation may not:

- replace the player's faction allegiance;
- receive sovereign status merely because it operates a colony;
- become a hidden fourth or fifth faction;
- overrule local law without a clearly written political conflict;
- erase the civilian government of a location from the lore;
- grant UGA voting rights through wealth alone.

11.1 Player-facing sponsorship model

The player chooses:

1. a sovereign faction;
2. a commander from that faction;
3. optionally, a non-sovereign sponsor or contract package.

A sponsor can change the source, appearance, or narrative framing of gear and resources without changing political allegiance. Rival sponsors within one faction create texture without fragmenting the faction-selection screen.

The Brood has no sponsor layer. Its equivalent variation is biological strain, environmental adaptation, hive objective, or infestation stage, all controlled by the scenario and AI.

12. Commander presentation rules

12.1 Character authority

The nine playable commanders are the current base roster. Their rank, personality, and service history belong to their sovereign faction even when their immediate organization is more specific.

The Brood's three named minds are encounter identities only. They do not make the Brood playable.

12.2 Visual canon

DIRECTED CANON - `commander-anime-flat-v1`:

- Human commanders use an anime-flat illustration style.
- Robotic commanders or robotic command avatars use the same flat visual language.
- Lines are crisp, deliberate, and readable at phone scale.
- Forms use solid color separation.
- No painted shading, airbrushed gradients, glossy rendering, cinematic rim light, or PBR lighting may define the portrait.
- Silhouette, face, insignia, and faction color must remain legible at small size.
- A faction may change shape language, uniform, palette, and iconography without breaking the common portrait style.

Brood encounter art may use organic silhouettes and disturbing biological forms, but it should still prioritize clean visual readability rather than photoreal gore.

12.3 Writing voices

Voice	Language rule
Nova	Professional, doctrinal, humane, precise, and understated
Crimson	Imperial, severe, unsentimental, declarative, and concerned with strength/order
Syndicate	Mercantile, clinical, witty when useful, and concerned with value/information
UGA	Restrained, procedural, neutral, evidence-led, and careful about mandate
Brood	Physical, organic, sensory, collective; never casually mechanical or commercial

13. Inter-faction relations

Nova and the Crimson Dominion

Nova sees the Dominion as proof that emergency defence can devour the society it claims to protect. The Dominion sees Nova's consensus as a luxury purchased by stronger people holding the frontier. Their shared military history - especially Vex's Federation training - makes the conflict personal as well as ideological.

Nova and the Syndicate Coalition

They cooperate on transit, science, logistics, and reconstruction, but disagree over who owns strategic data and whether public safety can be left to contract. Nova fears that the Syndicate sells common security; the Syndicate fears that Nova turns standards into soft control.

Crimson Dominion and the Syndicate Coalition

The Dominion wants predictable obedience; the Syndicate monetizes ambiguity. They trade when it is profitable, sanction one another when it is useful, and conduct constant intelligence and procurement warfare beneath formal agreements.

The sovereign powers and the UGA

All three need the UGA's neutral corridors, arbitration, evidence standards, and relief capacity. All three also accuse it of bias whenever a ruling limits their freedom. This tension is healthy for the setting: the UGA matters because it has enough authority to frustrate power, but not enough to abolish politics.

Civilization and the Brood

Brood containment is the one issue that can produce genuine joint command. Cooperation remains unstable because each faction suspects the others of using the emergency to seize territory, technology, or legitimacy.

14. Narrative architecture

14.1 Faction arcs

Nova Coalition: **LANDING** → **RELIEF CORRIDOR** → **PLANETARY SHIELD** Hold Aelos, restore the Sombrero command lattice, protect civilian continuity, and build a defensive alliance strong enough to survive the next incursion.

Crimson Dominion: **CONQUEST** → **WAR FORGES** → **IMPERIAL ASCENSION** Seize Pyraeth's pre-collapse war forges and prove that one authority can unify the theatre, while revealing the cost of unity imposed by force.

Syndicate Coalition: **INFILTRATION** → **MACHINE AWAKENING** → **PERFECT NETWORK** Awaken Nordhall's buried planetary intelligence and connect markets and defence networks, while deciding whether indispensability is service or domination.

Brood threat: **REALITY BLEED** → **PLANETARY NERVOUS SYSTEM** → **CONSUMPTION** Spread through wounds, turn infrastructure and ecology into hive anatomy, and make separate living worlds continuous with the Brood.

14.2 Shared campaign spine

PROPOSED:

1. The three powers fight localized wars over transit, resources, and recovering infrastructure.
2. Evidence shows that apparently separate outbreaks share one infestation pattern.
3. Each power tries to contain or exploit the threat alone.
4. A failed unilateral operation produces refugees, quarantine conflict, and political blame.
5. The UGA brokers a limited joint-containment mandate.
6. Internal organizations and corporate sponsors compete to shape the response.
7. The alliance fractures over territory, classified research, and acceptable losses.
8. The final campaign turns on control of the mass-energy lattice and whether it can be used without widening the reality wounds.

The Brood does not need to become sympathetic for this story to have moral complexity. The moral choices come from how the civilizations respond.

15. World and colony dossier standard

Every authored world, colony, city, or station should answer:

Field	Required content
Name and implementation key	Stable lore name plus technical identifier, if one exists
Location class	World, moon, colony, city, station, ring, ship, relay, or derelict
Legal status	Sovereign, disputed, treaty-neutral, UGA-administered, quarantined, infested, consumed, or abandoned
Sovereign or former sovereign	Exactly who governs it, claims it, or governed it before loss
Local administration	Council, prefect, charter board, governor, mandate office, or none
Civil population	Who lives there and how civilian life functions
Principal settlements	Capital, cities, colonies, ports, and stations
Economy	Food, industry, research, trade, salvage, transit, or another material purpose
Military role	Defence, logistics, shipyard, listening post, fortress, training, or demilitarized
Corporate presence	Named concession, sponsor, contractor, or explicitly none
UGA presence	Embassy, inspection, relief, peacekeeping, quarantine, or none
Brood status	None, alert, incursion, infestation, consumption, or recovered
Cultural identity	What residents value, celebrate, fear, and remember
Story conflict	The local political or survival problem that can create missions

No new location is ready for canon if its sovereign and civilian status are unclear.

16. Working historical sequence

Dates and calendar names are not yet locked. The safe relative sequence is:

1. Human or multispecies settlement expands through connected systems.
2. The political traditions that become Nova, the Dominion, and the Syndicate take shape.
3. The Red Ascendancy breaks with or grows out of Federation military culture and establishes Dominion rule.
4. Syndicate worlds ratify a shared charter and arbitration network.
5. The UGA treaty system forms to regulate transit, conflict, relief, and shared hazards.
6. Strategic lattice infrastructure is discovered, restored, or expanded.
7. Reality wounds and early Brood incursions are identified.
8. Vespera is overrun and becomes the defining consumed-world warning.
9. The Aelos landing and the current four-system crisis begin.

Every dated history added later should preserve this causal order unless the creator explicitly changes it.

17. Optional exploration-module boundary

The space-exploration module is isolated experimental work. Its material must be reconciled before promotion.

Usable concepts include:

- the full name **United Galactic Authority**;
- a UGA civilization ship such as **NEXUS-VII**;
- Coalition embassies and resident delegations;
- neutral survey, research, relief, logistics, and containment functions;
- sites such as Caldris Orbital Ring, Heliograph Relay, Morrow Freeport, Orison Derelict, Ossuary Vault, and Meridian Colony, after their locations and sovereign status are corrected.

Material that is not automatically canon:

- Nova Expeditionary Compact as a replacement for Nova Coalition or Terran Frontline Command;
- Dominion Iron Assembly as a replacement for Crimson Dominion;
- Syndicate Veil Network as a replacement for Syndicate Coalition;
- UGA “civilization authority” wording that implies galactic sovereignty;
- optional commanders whose names overlap or conflict with the base roster;
- any map that changes Aelos from a planet into a system;
- any hierarchy that places Veyra or Karak in conflict with the four-system base map;
- any wording that treats Vespera as a legitimate Brood polity.

If retained, the optional faction labels should become mission contingents, industrial bodies, intelligence networks, or expedition contracts beneath the canonical entities.

18. Canon locks and forbidden implications

The following rules are mandatory unless the creator explicitly revises them:

- There are **three playable sovereign factions**, not four.
- The Nova Coalition, Crimson Dominion, and Syndicate Coalition govern populated territory.
- Terran Frontline Command is part of Nova, not a separate sovereign faction.
- Red Ascendancy is part of the Dominion's political history and structure, not another selectable red faction.
- Machine Ascendancy and Emerald Triad do not create additional selectable green factions.
- The UGA is neutral and non-selectable.
- The UGA does not own member worlds or command every member military.
- Corporations, guilds, directorates, formations, ministries, and sponsors are non-selectable.
- A corporate concession must name the sovereign law under which it operates.
- The Brood is hostile and AI-controlled.
- The Brood has no government, cities, colonies, civilian economy, corporations, or legal territory.
- The Brood does not manufacture vehicles, factories, or weapons.
- Vespera is infested or consumed, not governed as a Brood homeworld.

- Technical keys such as **legion**, **ascendancy**, **horde**, and **uga** do not prove political equivalence.
 - Human and robotic commander portraits follow the flat-anime, crisp-line, no-shading visual rule.
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19. Open canon decisions

These decisions are deliberately visible rather than hidden inside prose:

1. Confirm whether **Nova Coalition** completely replaces **Nova Federation** as the sovereign name, or whether “Federation” remains the constitutional name inside the Coalition.
 2. Confirm the working red hierarchy: **Crimson Dominion** as the state and **Red Ascendancy** as its ruling movement.
 3. Decide whether the three featured powers are the UGA's only full members or only the principal powers in this theatre.
 4. Define UGA voting, veto, funding, sanctions, and peacekeeping limits.
 5. Name and locate the additional worlds and colonies already implied for each sovereign power.
 6. Decide Vespera's pre-infestation sovereign, refugee nationality, and surviving legal claim.
 7. Decide whether a consumed world becomes ecologically dead, remains a living hive ecology, or can exist in either state.
 8. Decide whether the Brood is one distributed intelligence, several Sovereigns, or a hierarchy of linked minds.
 9. Establish the calendar, current year, UGA founding era, and Brood first-contact date.
 10. Decide whether the setting's political populations are human-only or multispecies.
 11. Reconcile the four-system base theatre with the optional Aelos - Veyra - Karak exploration route.
 12. Approve, rename, or reject each proposed corporate sponsor.
 13. Decide whether apparent Brood communication can ever be genuine exchange while keeping the Brood outside recognized diplomacy.
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20. Source and proposal ledger

Live base sources consulted

- `src/faction-id.js` - stable faction identities, display names, aliases, and runtime-key mapping.
- `src/factions.js` - faction doctrine, homeworld anchors, mottos, commanders, goals, rosters, and Brood biological rules.
- `src/story.js` - commander biographies, service organizations, faction voices, and dispatch language.
- `src/factext.js` - faction-specific vocabulary and the rule that Brood language remains organic rather than mechanical.
- `src/engine/gl.js` - four-system/world presentation and named planetary regions.

Optional sources consulted

- `modules/space_exploration/README.md` - isolation boundary, UGA sponsor role, resident factions, and hostile-only Brood rule.
- `modules/space_exploration/src/domain/catalog.js` - United Galactic Authority name, NEXUS-era expedition concepts, optional sites, and conflicting faction labels.
- `modules/space_exploration/src/systems/showcase_systems.js` - optional world and station presentation requiring hierarchy reconciliation.

Implementation consequences for later stages

- Faction-selection UI should expose only Nova, Crimson, and Syndicate.
- Commander selection remains nested under the chosen sovereign faction.
- Sponsor selection, if implemented, is a subordinate loadout or contract choice.
- The UGA appears through missions, diplomacy, relief, standards, and containment - not faction selection.
- Brood hives and minds appear through enemy/scenario selection, never player sovereignty.
- Location data should carry explicit legal and infestation status.
- Base and exploration naming should be reconciled before the optional module is promoted.
- Display-name changes must preserve stable save/runtime identifiers.
- Narrative copy must use [govern/administer/infest](#) according to the entity's legal nature.

This document authorizes further lore development within these boundaries. It does not itself register new factions, assets, commanders, corporations, worlds, or gameplay content.